Complete Beginner's Guide

GitHub, Codespaces, Claude Code & RuFlo

A step-by-step setup guide for complete beginners

HeroForge.AI

Before You Start

Make sure you have the following ready before beginning:

•	**Computer with internet access** – Required for all steps
•	**Email address** – For account creation
•	**30 minutes** – Approximate setup time
•	**Credit card** – For Claude Code authentication (explained in the guide)

Part 1: Creating Your GitHub Account

GitHub is where your code will live. Creating an account is free and takes just a few minutes. GitHub provides a generous free tier for basic usage, including storage and codespaces. Consider a paid account for larger machine types and increased storage.

Step 1: Go to GitHub's Website

1. Open your web browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, or Edge).
2. Type github.com into the address bar and press Enter.
3. You will see GitHub's homepage.

Step 2: Sign Up for an Account

1. Click the **Sign up** button in the top-right corner.
2. Enter your email address and click **Continue.**
3. Create a strong password using letters, numbers, and symbols.
4. Choose a username. This will be your identity on GitHub.
5. Complete any verification puzzles GitHub presents.
6. Check your email for a verification code from GitHub.
7. Enter the verification code on the GitHub page.

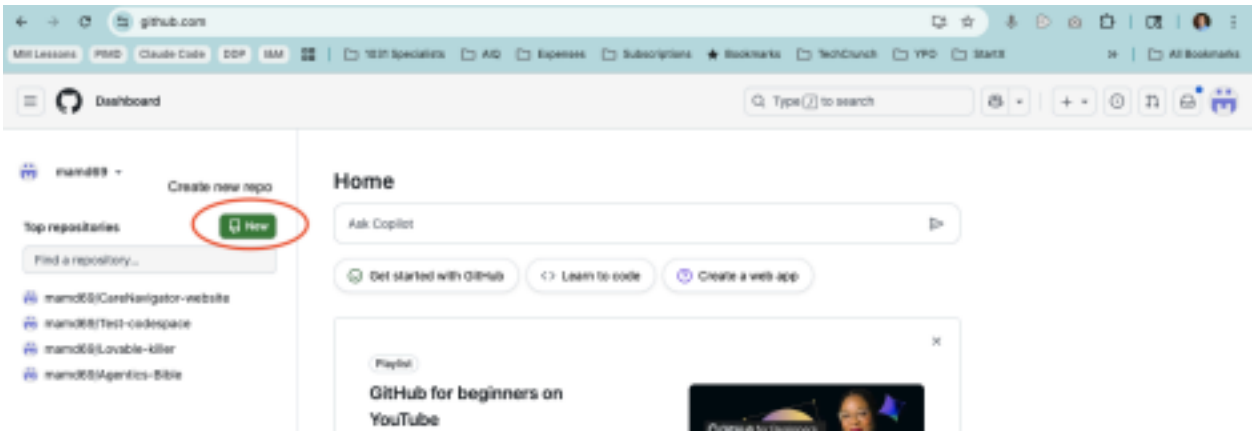
> Congratulations! You now have a GitHub account.

Part 2: Creating Your First Repository

A repository (or "repo") is like a project folder that stores your code and files.

Step 1: Create a New Repository

1. After logging in, click the **New** button, or click the **+** icon in the top-right corner.
2. Select **New repository.**



Step 2: Set Up Your Repository

1. **Repository name:** Type a name for your project (example: my-first-project).
2. **Description (optional):** Add a brief description such as "My first GitHub project."
3. **Visibility:** Choose **Public** if you want others to be able to find and copy it, or **Private** to control access.
4. **Add README:** Check this box.
5. Click the **Create repository** button at the bottom.

> Great job! You have created your first repository.

Part 3: Opening a GitHub Codespace

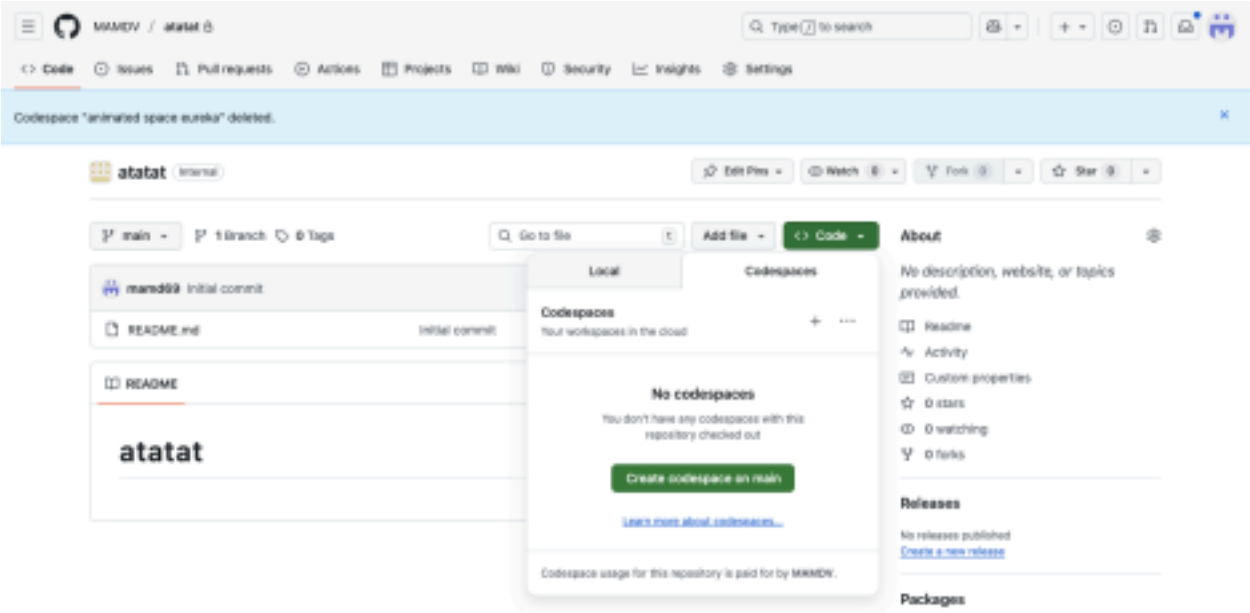
GitHub Codespaces gives you a complete development environment running in your browser, with no software installation required.

Step 1: Open Codespaces from Your Repository

Choose one of the following options:

Option A: Use VS Code in the Browser

1. From your repository's main page, click the **Code** button.
2. Click the **Codespaces** tab.
3. Click **Create codespace on main.**



Option B: Use VS Code Desktop (Preferred if Already Installed)

1. In VS Code Desktop, open a New Window.
2. Click **Start** then **Connect to...**
3. Choose **Connect New Codespace.**
4. Select the repository you just created.

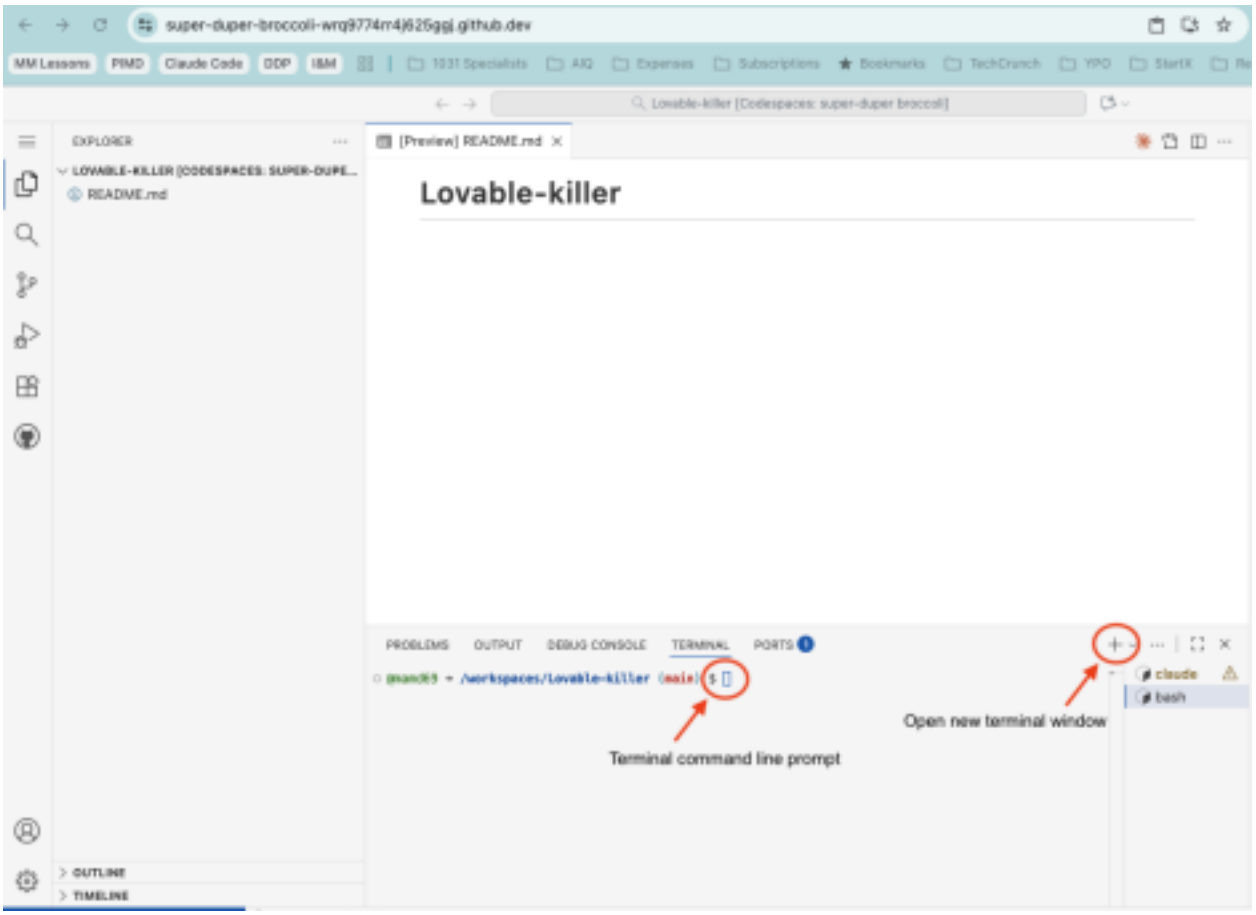
Step 2: Wait for Your Codespace to Start

- GitHub will take 1 to 2 minutes to set up your coding environment.
- You will see a loading screen with progress messages.
- When it is ready, you will see a code editor that looks like Visual Studio Code.

Step 3: Familiarize Yourself with the Interface

Your Codespace has three main areas:

- **Left sidebar:** File explorer where you can see your project files.
- **Center area:** Code editor where you write and view code.
- **Bottom panel:** Terminal where you type commands.



Important: Keep this window open. You will use it throughout the following steps.

Part 4: Installing Claude Code

Claude Code is an AI-powered coding assistant that runs in your terminal.

Step 1: Open the Terminal in Your Codespace

5. In your Codespace, look at the bottom panel.
6. You should see a tab labeled **Terminal.**
7. If the terminal is not visible, press Ctrl + ` (the backtick key, usually located below the Esc key).

Step 2: Install Claude Code

Copy and paste the following command into your terminal and press Enter:

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
```

What this does: This command installs Claude Code so you can use it from anywhere in your terminal. Wait for the installation to complete (approximately 1 to 2 minutes).

Step 3: Create Claude Code Aliases

You will create two shortcuts:

- **`dsp`** – Runs Claude Code without permission prompts.
- **`dsp-c`** – Runs Claude Code without permission prompts, resuming the last session's context.

First, exit Claude Code by typing exit. Then run the following in your terminal:

```
echo -e "alias dsp='claude --dangerously-skip-permissions'\nalias dsp-c='claude --
dangerously-skip-permissions -c'" >> ~/.bashrc
```

Then:

```
source ~/.bashrc
```

Security note: The --dangerously-skip-permissions flag allows Claude to run commands without asking for confirmation each time. This is required for agentic workflows. Only use it in environments you control, such as your own Codespace.

Part 5: Installing RuFlo

RuFlo is an agentic orchestration platform that lets you run multiple pre-built AI agents simultaneously to accelerate development.

Step 1: Install RuFlo

Run the following command in your terminal:

```
curl -fsSL https://cdn.jsdelivr.net/gh/ruvnet/claude-flow@main/scripts/install.sh |
bash -s -- --full
```

Wait 1 to 2 minutes for the installation to complete.

Part 5: Run Claude Code and RuFlo

Step 1: Run Claude Code

Try your new shortcut in the terminal:

```
dsp
```

You will be prompted to choose a display mode. Enter 1 for dark mode or 2 for light mode.

Step 2: Authenticate Claude Code

Before you can use Claude Code, you need to connect it to your Anthropic account.

1. **Enter 1** if you have a Claude Max account, or **Enter 2** if you have a $20/month account with API billing enabled.
2. You will see a message similar to "Please visit this URL to authenticate..." Click the link, or copy and paste it into a new browser tab.
3. You will be taken to the Anthropic website. Click Authorize.
4. Paste the key provided into the Claude Code prompt in your Codespace.

> **Known issue:** You may see an error the first time you click Authorize. If this happens, return to your Codespace tab and click the link again while holding the Cmd key (Mac) or Ctrl key (Windows). Then click Authorize again.

> **Important:** Make sure you are logged into the Claude account where billing is enabled. Your account information is shown at the bottom of the authorization page.

Setting Up a Claude Account (If You Do Not Have One)

You will need one of the following:

- **Pro account ($20/month)** plus API billing enabled at platform.claude.com/settings/billing
- **Max account ($100/month or $200/month)**

> **Recommendation:** Start with the Pro account plus API billing unless you plan to use Claude Code every day. If you are a heavy daily user, the Max $200/month plan is more cost-effective given typical API usage.

Step 3: Approve Dangerously Skip Permissions

The first time you run dsp, it will still require your approval. After that, it will run without interruption.

Setup Complete

Congratulations! You have successfully completed the following:

- ✓ Created a GitHub account
- ✓ Created your first repository
- ✓ Opened a GitHub Codespace
- ✓ Installed Claude Code
- ✓ Created the dsp and dsp-c bash aliases
- ✓ Installed RuFlo

> **New to Ruflo?** You don't need to learn 259 MCP tools or 26 CLI commands. After running init, just use Claude Code normally — the hooks system automatically routes tasks to the right agents, learns from successful patterns, and coordinates multi-agent work in the background. The advanced tools exist for fine-grained control when you need it.

Exploring Capabilities

Use these prompts inside Claude Code to discover what RuFlo can do:

```
tell me about ruflo and its development capabilities and the ADR/DDD. be brief
tell me about the helpers and what they do
tell me which helpers are activated
```

> **Tip:** Helpers are activated in settings.json. You can enable auto-commit.sh to automatically save versions of your work. Once enabled, you can say things like "restore to the version from 10 minutes ago."

What You Can Do Now

- **Start a coding project:** Ask RuFlo to help you build something.
- **Create AI agent swarms:** Coordinate multiple AI assistants on the same task.
- **Explore SPARC modes:** Different AI development patterns for specific types of work.
- **Build with confidence:** You have AI-powered tools ready to help you code.

Getting Help

Claude Code documentation: https://docs.claude.com/en/docs/claude-code
RuFlo GitHub:https://github.com/ruvnet/ruflo
GitHub Help: https://docs.github.com

Pro Tips

1. **Save frequently:** Use Ctrl + S, or enable Auto Save under File > Auto Save (enabled by default in VS Code Web).
2. **Use multiple terminals:** Click the + icon at the top of the terminal panel to open a new tab. This is helpful when tasks need to run in parallel or in sequence.

3. **Commit your work:** Use Git and GitHub commands regularly to save versions of your project.
4. **Read error messages carefully:** They usually tell you exactly what went wrong and how to fix it.
5. **Ask Claude anything:** You can ask it to explain code, fix bugs, or generate new features. The key is to be specific.

Quick Reference: All Commands

Install Claude Code

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
```

Add Shortcuts (Codespace or Linux)

```
echo -e "alias dsp='claude --dangerously-skip-permissions'\nalias dsp-c='claude --dangerously-skip-permissions -c'" >> ~/.bashrc
```

```
source ~/.bashrc
```

Add Shortcuts (Mac Desktop, Global)

```
echo "alias dsp='claude --dangerously-skip-permissions'\nalias dsp-c='claude --dangerously-skip-permissions -c'" >> ~/.zshrc
```

```
source ~/.zshrc
```

Install RuFlo

```
# One-line install (recommended)
curl -fsSL https://cdn.jsdelivr.net/gh/ruvnet/claude-flow@main/scripts/install.sh | bash

# Full setup with MCP and diagnostics (use at HeroForge)
curl -fsSL https://cdn.jsdelivr.net/gh/ruvnet/claude-flow@main/scripts/install.sh | bash -s -- --full
```

Verify Installation

```
claude mcp list
```

Methodology

4-Steps to Mastery

Step 1: Brainstorm

Use the goal-planner agent to generate a research document

```
use @"goal-planner (agent)" to evaluate [area, task, documents, features] and create a
academic-quality research document in /docs/research/[name.md]
```

Step 2: Create Plans

```
Using /docs/research/[name.md], create detailed docs/ADRs +/- docs/DDDs, plus a
docs/plan/implementation-pland.md that will guide me through my sprints. (don't
implement)
```

Step 3: Implementation

```
implement ADR [numbers]. spawn swarm, implement completely, test, validate, benchmark,
optimize, document. continue until complete.
```

Step 4: User Test, Fix Bugs, and Enhance

```
Give me a user testing guide.  Prove to me that this works, etc.
```

Best Practices

- **Do not paste large amounts of text directly into Claude Code.** Put content into files and reference those files by path instead.
- **Use multiple terminal windows** when tasks need to run in parallel or in a specific sequence.
- **Use Claude Code Web simultaneously** on the same project when you step away from your desktop. Note that Claude Code Web supports a maximum of 15 agents at once.